

Koustubh Kulkarni

CommunityLeader · Community-LedGrowth · Ambassador & Advocacy Programs

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PROFILE

Head of Community & Growth with 7 years at Under25, India's leading youth platform. I've spent my career building communities across 300+ colleges, bringing together 225,000+ students and 2,000+ student ambassadors. From student programs and campus networks to digital products, content and large-scale offline experiences, my work has always been about putting community at the centre of the brand. I've helped build Under25 Summit at Campus into a ₹10 Cr+ sponsorship revenue business, managed a ₹10 Cr+ annual P&L, and led a 75-member team across 5 cities.

I enjoy creating spaces and experiences where people feel seen, find their people, and feel like they belong. My focus is on building communities that don't just drive growth, but create genuine connection, brand love, and a reason for people to keep coming back.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- Community Strategy & Operating Models
- Retention Loops & Engagement Design
- University Relations & Management
- Community-Led Growth & Product Adoption
- Offline IP Design & Development
- IP Scaling & Expansion
- Ambassador & Advocacy Programs
- Experience Design
- Artist & Talent Curation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Under25 – India's Largest Youth Brand Bangalore & Mumbai, India | July 2019 – Present

India's largest youth media and community network - 300+ campuses, 1M+ app users, 350M+ organic reach.

CAREER PROGRESSION AT UNDER25

Campus Fellow → Community Manager (2021) → Lead, User Advocacy & Community Programs (Mar 2023) → Festival Director, Under25 Summit Bangalore (Mar 2024) → **Head of Community** (Apr 2025)

Themes below span multiple roles.
Core responsibilities and key achievements across my tenure:

National Campus IP: Under25 Summit at Campus 2021 – 2024 · [\[Link\]](#)

- Scaled across **300+ colleges** including IITs, IIMs, SRCC, St. Xavier's, Christ, NIFT, NMIMS, Symbiosis and SRM Chennai.
- Reached **225,000+ attendees**, curating **800+ speakers** and **500+ student performers** with **zero paid media spend** — every campus getting its own version of Under25.

Offline to Online Growth: Product Adoption & App Funnel 2022 – Present · [\[Link\]](#)

- Designed check-ins, exclusive perks and on-ground touchpoints that drove **200,000+ app downloads** through live IPs.
- Grew the user base from **500 to 1M**, turning the offline experience into the entry point for a deeper digital community.

Micro IP Curation: Under25 IRL 2023 – Present · [\[Link\]](#)

- Conceptualised and launched **Under25 IRL — 45 invite-only gatherings** for rising creators, musicians and subculture leaders, ~50 guests per event.
- Built smaller, more personal spaces where people could meet, share and feel comfortable being themselves — and grew **@Under25IRL from 0 to 4.5K** in 4 months.

Community Led Content & Brand Storytelling 2022 – Present · [\[Link\]](#)

- Grew **@Under25AtCampus from 0 to 26K** followers in 24 months, generating **350M+ organic views** with zero paid media.
- Built content around real community moments and the people who make Under25 what it is, letting the community tell its own story.

Grassroots Campus Network & Brand Activations

2019 – Present · [\[Link\]](#)

- Built and led a student ambassador program of **1,000+ Campus Fellows** across **200 colleges**.
- Gave fellows a real role in shaping the brand on their campuses, building local communities and driving **45,000+ ticket sales over 5 years**.
- Led brand delivery across this campus footprint for **Google, OnePlus, CRED, Zerodha and Goibibo** — activations, interactive kiosks and stage integrations that added to the experience instead of sitting on top of it.

Community Led Festival Building & Marketing

2022 – 2024 · [\[Link\]](#)

- Led **ATL and BTL marketing**, student outreach, ticket sales, partnerships, pre-events and on-ground execution for Under25's flagship festivals.
- Designed a three-month festival-building journey and mentored a **4,000-member student crew**, giving students ownership of ticket sales, pre-events, partner onboarding and running the festival:
 - Summit Bangalore 2023: **24,000+ tickets sold, 55,000+ footfall, 300+ artists**
 - Summit Bangalore 2024: **8,000+ tickets sold, 15,000+ footfall, 30+ artists**

EARLIER AT UNDER25

Community Manager: Student Creator Fellowship

Nov 2021 – Oct 2022 · [\[Link\]](#)

- Built a **500-creator advocacy program** from zero and managed a **2,000+ member community** year-round.
- Executed **18 advocacy campaigns** for CRED, OnePlus, Snapdragon, Zebpay, EatFit, Azorte, Kotex and Schneider — **~2,500 pieces** of community-created content.
- Routed **₹25L+ directly into members' pockets** by structuring campaigns as paid creator work, and ran the Academy enablement series with mentors including Rohan Joshi and Vijay Subramaniam.

Intern: Campus Representative

July 2019 – Nov 2021 · [\[Link\]](#)

- Ran a national outreach campaign that drove **8,700 community applications** in a single year, and activated a **100-member UGC community** on Triller generating **7,000+ videos and 15M+ views**.
- Led a 25-student campus team at MIT-WPU and grew @under25mitwpu; named **Festival Director of the Year (2020)**.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Administration MIT-WPU,Pune · Specialisation in Event Management & Marketing Vice President, Entrepreneurship Club	2019 – 2021 9.44 CGPA
Class XII — Commerce Sinhgad College of Commerce, Pune	2018 76.76%
Class X — CBSE Billabong International School, Mumbai	2016 7.2 CGPA

SKILLS & TOOLS

TECHNICAL	Excel & Google Sheets (Budgeting, P&L, Forecasting) · Canva · Agent Workflows · ATL & BTL Campaign Strategy · Offline Experiential Marketing · Influencer Marketing · User Engagement & Retention Strategy · Community Strategy · Content Creation · Creative Direction · Event Curation · User Onboarding · User Incentive & Rewards Program Design
LEADERSHIP	Team building & org design · Distributed team leadership across 5 cities · Hiring & performance management · Volunteer and student crew structures at scale · Mentoring & developing student leaders · P&L ownership & vendor negotiation · Sponsor and client servicing · Public speaking & event hosting · Cross-functional partnership
LANGUAGES	English · Hindi · Marathi